

TAB 17



Board of Education Report

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Mr. Schmerelson - Celebrating Los Angeles Unified School District's Classified Employees' Service, Skill and Long-Standing Commitment to Our Communities as well as Classified School Employee Week 2023 (Res-016-22/23) (For Action May 9, 2023)

Whereas, The Los Angeles Unified School District recognizes the over 32,000 classified employees who are dedicated in their service to public education and a vital part of the District;

Whereas, Classified employees play a key role in supporting students' academic success by assisting over 400,000 students inside and outside of the classroom in grades ETK-12, more than 22,000 students in Early Education programs and, more than 20,000 students accomplishing their career goals in Adult and Career Education Centers;

Whereas, Classified employees are essential to the District's operations providing daily service to the students, faculty, staff and families through their hard work as school employees, including clerical and technical employees, as well as bus drivers, instructional aides, library aides, paraeducators, special education assistants, library and media assistants, food service providers, security officers, computer services maintenance workers and others;

Whereas, Classified employees have earned respect as educators and partners in the education community while making a difference in the lives of the students they serve;

Whereas, Labor partners including Service Employees International Union (SEIU) Local 99, Teamsters Local 572, California School Employee Association (CSEA) Chapter 500, Los Angeles/Orange Counties Building and Construction Trades Council, Associated Administrators of Los Angeles (AALA), Los Angeles School Police Association (LASPA) and the Los Angeles School Police Management Association (LASPMA) represent classified employees who work tirelessly to serve students and ensure a supportive, clean, safe and comfortable learning environment for both the students and faculty of the District;

Whereas, During the regular academic year classified employees in the District safely transport approximately 41,000 students to and from school each day by bus; serve over 720,000 meals to students each day (including 400,000 breakfasts, 350,000 lunches, and 80,000 supper and snack meals per day); create and sustain a learning environment with clean and operational facilities and classrooms, and maintain an inviting landscape at more than 1,000 District schools and other facilities that students, parents, and the community can be proud of;

Whereas, Classified employees were an integral part of the District's landmark response to the COVID-19 pandemic and its impact on the families the District proudly serves. Since the start of the pandemic, Classified Employees served over 132 million meals at our Grab-and-Go Centers, routinely clean and sanitize schools and offices allowing for the adherence to essential safety protocols, distributed hundreds of thousands of devices and hotspots to students and families for distance learning, supported the administration of over 14.7 million COVID-19 tests and the distribution of over 120,000 vaccines as of March 2022;

Whereas, In 1986, the California State Legislature decreed the third full week of May each year as Classified School Employee Week in official recognition of classified school employees, by passage of Senate Bill 1552 (Campbell); and

Whereas, This year the California School Employees Association's theme for Classified School Employee Week is Classified Professionals: Indispensable, Inspiring & Invincible; now, therefore, be it

Resolved, That the Governing Board of the Los Angeles Unified School District hereby declares the week of May 21-27, 2023 as Classified School Employee Week in the District and encourages the celebration of classified school employees at our schools and throughout the District for their hard work and unwavering dedication to our students, families, and schools and the invaluable contributions they make to our educational community; and, be it finally

Resolved, That the Board hereby recognizes and greatly appreciates the contributions and dedicated service of classified professionals to quality education in the District and the State of California.